

Practical AI Workflows

Hands-on workflow training for writing, planning, research support, meeting preparation, and everyday knowledge work.

Format	Two 90-minute Zoom sessions or one half-day remote workshop.
Level	Level 2: practical workflow fluency
Audience	Teams and professionals who already understand the basics and want practical routines they can reuse.

Learner outcomes

- Build repeatable workflows for common work without copying sensitive data into public tools.
- Use AI to generate first drafts, alternatives, summaries, meeting artifacts, and decision support.
- Identify where AI can speed work by drafting, sorting, sequencing, and preparing review-ready artifacts.
- Develop review habits that keep the human responsible for quality, context, and final judgment.
- Turn scattered experiments into documented workflow recipes that can be shared inside a team.
- Package proven prompt sequences into narrow Gems, custom GPTs, project assistants, or similar specialty helpers.

Guiding questions

- Which tasks repeat often enough to deserve a workflow?
- Where can AI help without becoming the decision maker?
- What work currently stalls because the first draft, first sort, or first plan takes too long to begin?
- What inputs are safe to use, and what must be abstracted or withheld?
- How will we review, revise, and document the workflow so others can use it?
- When should a workflow remain a prompt recipe, and when is it mature enough to become a specialty assistant?

Readiness checks

- The workflow has a named owner and a clear final human decision point.

- Inputs avoid sensitive or proprietary data unless a suitable private environment is approved.
- The workflow includes a review step for accuracy, tone, assumptions, and missing context.
- The team can explain when the workflow is useful and when it should not be used.
- Any specialty assistant has written boundaries, safe test cases, review requirements, and an owner for updates.

Research-backed adoption practices

- Prioritize recurring tasks that consume real time or create repeated rework, not flashy demos.
- Break each workflow into inputs, AI assistance, review checkpoints, handoffs, and final ownership.
- Measure usefulness in time saved, quality improved, rework reduced, and review burden created.
- Track concrete before-and-after artifacts so learners can see where AI shortened drafting, sorting, sequencing, or follow-up.
- Document the workflow recipe so a useful experiment can become a teachable team practice.
- Promote only stable, well-reviewed recipes into Gems, custom GPTs, project spaces, or other reusable assistants.

Curriculum modules

Workflow anatomy

We break a task into input, constraints, AI assist, review, revision, and final human decision.

Writing and rewriting

Participants practice using AI for tone, structure, audience adaptation, and first-pass drafting.

Research support without overtrust

We separate brainstorming, query planning, summarization, source checking, and final verification.

Meetings and decisions

Participants create safe workflows for agendas, prep notes, follow-up drafts, and option comparison.

Workflow acceleration cases

We compare real-world patterns such as meeting follow-through, donor updates, admin FAQs, proposal prep, onboarding kits, and feedback synthesis.

Workflow documentation

Teams capture the steps, prompts, inputs, review points, and human decisions that make a workflow repeatable.

Specialty assistant builder

Learners turn one reliable workflow into a narrow Gem-style helper with operating instructions, safe source material, test cases, and maintenance notes.

First prompting lab

These short starter activities help learners experience prompt design before longer workflow projects. They are adapted from the activity patterns researched on Everybody Prompts and similar beginner practice formats.

Ask-for-a-prompt warmup (Pre-prompting)

Learners discover that prompting can begin by asking the model to help shape the prompt itself.

Build: A reusable prompt card with task, audience, context, constraints, output format, and review criteria.

Safe input: Use a public topic, fictional scenario, or harmless personal learning goal.

Starter prompt: I want to use AI for [safe topic or task], but I am not sure how to prompt well. Ask me up to five clarifying questions, then give me three prompt options: quick, structured, and advanced. Include what each prompt is good for and what I should check afterward.

Structured research table (Basic research prompting)

Students learn to ask for organized output instead of accepting a long, shapeless answer.

Build: A comparison table with columns the learner specified, plus a list of claims to verify.

Safe input: Use a public topic such as renewable energy, storage devices, local history, or a general product category.

Starter prompt: Create a beginner-friendly research table about [public topic]. Use columns for concept, short explanation, practical use, common confusion, and what to verify in reliable sources. After the table, suggest three better follow-up questions.

Timeline builder (Chronological organization)

Students see how prompt format changes understanding by turning a topic into sequence, development, and context.

Build: A chronological timeline with significance notes and uncertainty flags.

Safe input: Use public historical, technical, cultural, or organizational topics.

Starter prompt: Create a chronological timeline for [public topic]. Include year or period, event, why it mattered, what changed afterward, and confidence level. Mark anything that needs source checking.

Email tone trio (Business email drafting)

Learners experience AI as a writing partner while keeping voice, promises, and final judgment human-led.

Build: Three email versions, a tone comparison, and a send-before-review checklist.

Safe input: Use a fictional or sanitized email scenario with no customer, patient, employee, financial, or proprietary details.

Starter prompt: Using this fictional email scenario, draft three versions: concise, warm, and more formal. Explain what changed in each version, recommend one, and list facts, promises, names, dates, and tone choices a human should confirm before sending: [scenario].

Image observation drill (Image description)

Students distinguish visible evidence from inference, uncertainty, and possible overclaiming.

Build: A two-column observation table separating what is visible from what is inferred.

Safe input: Use a public-domain, stock, classroom, or non-sensitive image. Avoid faces or private settings unless permissions are clear.

Starter prompt: Describe this image for a careful learner. Separate visible details from inferences. Add a table with observation, evidence in the image, confidence, and what should not be assumed. Finish with three questions a human reviewer should ask.

Career fit map (Career research)

Learners practice giving context, asking for options, and requesting useful decision criteria.

Build: A career option table with fit reasons, education paths, tradeoffs, and next questions.

Safe input: Use a fictional profile or a sanitized personal summary that excludes private employer data, compensation, references, and confidential projects.

Starter prompt: Using this safe career profile, suggest career directions in a table with role, why it may fit, skills to build, typical education or training path, tradeoffs, and next research questions. Do not make the decision for me: [profile].

Proof-bank resume drill (Resume creation)

Students learn to turn scattered experience into defensible claims and then ask for critique.

Build: Six resume bullets, proof bank, critique table, and claims-to-evidence checklist.

Safe input: Use a fictional or sanitized work history without private employer details, references, compensation, or confidential outcomes.

Starter prompt: Turn this sanitized work history into a proof bank and six resume bullet options. For each bullet, list the evidence needed to support it, possible overstatement risk, and one stronger revision. Flag anything that sounds inflated: [work history].

Brand connotation check (Branding feedback)

Learners see how AI can brainstorm associations while human judgment still checks audience, culture, and evidence.

Build: A naming or messaging table with positive associations, risks, audience fit, and questions to test.

Safe input: Use fictional brand names, public examples, or early ideas that are not confidential.

Starter prompt: Evaluate these fictional brand or project names for connotations. Create a table with name, positive associations, possible drawbacks, audience fit, words to avoid, and questions we should test with real people: [names].

Survey cleanup and format (Survey construction)

Students learn to ask for editing, consistency, and application-ready formatting in one clear request.

Build: A cleaned survey list plus a format-ready version for a form tool or spreadsheet.

Safe input: Use fictional survey items or public workshop feedback questions. Avoid private personnel, patient, customer, or sensitive demographic data.

Starter prompt: Clean up these fictional survey items. Fix grammar, remove leading language, make the scale consistent, and return two outputs: a numbered review table and a form-ready list in the format [Required] [Question type] Question text: [items].

Chart storyboard (Chart creation)

Learners separate the data question, chart type, audience, and caveats before asking for a visual.

Build: A chart plan with data needed, recommended chart type, annotation ideas, and cautions.

Safe input: Use public data, fictional data, or a small hand-written sample. Do not use sensitive spreadsheets in public tools.

Starter prompt: Help me plan a chart for [public or fictional data topic]. Recommend chart type, needed columns, sample data structure, title, labels, annotations, caveats, and three checks before presenting the chart.

Cloze quiz maker (Quiz generation)

Students practice precise output instructions, distractor quality, and iterative repair.

Build: A short cloze quiz in table format with answer key, distractors, and a quality check.

Safe input: Use a public article, textbook excerpt you have rights to use, or original instructional text.

Starter prompt: Create a five-item cloze quiz from this public or original text. Return a table with sentence, missing term, three plausible distractors, correct answer, and explanation. Then critique the quiz for ambiguity and weak distractors: [text].

Lesson or page outline (Lesson plans and website pages)

Learners see how AI can structure material into a usable outline before any polished writing begins.

Build: A one-hour lesson plan or one-page website outline with sections, examples, activities, and review notes.

Safe input: Use public topic notes, fictional program descriptions, or sanitized learning goals.

Starter prompt: Turn this safe topic into a one-hour lesson plan or one-page website outline. Include audience, learning goals, section sequence, examples, activity ideas, plain-language explanations, and review questions. Mark assumptions and missing information: [topic notes].

Session flow

Select

Choose one or two common tasks with clear boundaries and enough repetition to justify practice.

Decompose

Break each task into inputs, decisions, drafts, checks, revisions, and final human ownership.

Build

Create prompt sequences and review steps using non-sensitive examples.

Estimate

Name where time might be saved, what review burden remains, and how the team will tell whether the workflow is worth keeping.

Stress test

Try edge cases, poor inputs, missing context, and output-review prompts.

Document

Capture the workflow as a short recipe that names when to use it and when not to.

Practice labs

Writing packet workflow

Build: intake questions, draft prompt, critique prompt, revision prompt, and final review checklist. Use: a public, fictional, or sanitized memo or FAQ. Do: draft, critique, revise, and document the sequence. Check: claims, voice, and final human approval.

Meeting-to-action workflow

Build: agenda, prep questions, decision log, action table, and follow-up message. Use: fictional or sanitized meeting context. Do: generate the packet and mark confirmations. Check: invented commitments, owner placeholders, and due dates.

Research triage board

Build: question clusters, source categories, search strings, blind spots, and claim-verification table. Use: a public topic or general business question. Do: plan research before collecting sources. Check: model output is not treated as evidence.

Decision-support brief

Build: criteria, option matrix, assumptions, pre-mortem, missing evidence, and human decision questions. Use: a fictional, public, or sanitized decision. Do: compare without choosing. Check: accountability remains with a person.

Workflow speed map

Build: a bottleneck map with before/after steps, safe AI-assist points, review gates, time-saved hypotheses, and stop signs. **Use:** a fictional, public, or sanitized recurring task such as intake sorting, donor updates, onboarding, proposal prep, or feedback review. **Do:** map current steps, mark AI assist points, and estimate review burden. **Check:** acceleration and accountability are both visible.

Gem-style specialty assistant blueprint

Build: job statement, instruction block, required questions, output format, review gates, safe examples, edge tests, and version notes. **Use:** a fictional, public, or sanitized repeated task. **Do:** write and test one narrow helper. **Check:** allowed inputs, stop signs, and human approval are explicit.

1-2 hour utility projects

These short projects are designed to help individuals experience practical AI utility while keeping inputs safe and human review visible.

How to choose a strong first project

- Real work, safe input: choose a task learners recognize, then substitute public, fictional, or sanitized material.
- Named walk-away artifact: produce a file, table, checklist, brief, agenda, glossary, recipe card, or other object.
- Visible human judgment: require the learner to check claims, reject weak output, revise tone, name uncertainty, or decide what stays human-led.
- Transferable next use: teach a repeatable pattern such as adding context, requesting structure, comparing alternatives, verifying claims, documenting the recipe, and trying it again.

Public Article Learning Kit (60-75 minutes)

Turn one public article into a tutor session and a usable study packet.

Walk-away artifact: A one-page explainer, eight-term glossary, five-question quiz, misconception list, and verification table.

Safe input: Use a public article, help page, announcement, or topic summary. Avoid private client, patient, employee, financial, legal, or proprietary material.

- Paste or summarize one public source and state your current knowledge level.
- Ask for an explainer, glossary, examples, and common misconceptions.
- Create a five-question quiz and answer it before looking at the answer key.
- Mark every claim that needs source checking before you share or rely on it.

Starter prompt: Use this public source to create a learning kit for a smart beginner: [public source or topic]. Produce a one-page explainer, eight-term glossary, three examples, common misconceptions, a five-question quiz with answer key, and a verification table listing claims I should check in reliable sources.

Decision Brief in a Box (75-90 minutes)

Use AI to structure a decision without handing the decision away.

Walk-away artifact: A one-page decision brief with criteria, option table, assumption register, pre-mortem, and next-evidence checklist.

Safe input: Use a personal, public, fictional, or sanitized decision. Keep confidential finances, contracts, medical, legal, or customer details out of public tools.

- Name two or three options, the decision deadline, constraints, and what success would look like.
- Ask for a weighted criteria table and force the model to show its assumptions.
- Run a pre-mortem for the most tempting option and a second pass for the safest option.
- Write three human-only judgment questions you will answer before acting.

Starter prompt: Help me build a decision brief without deciding for me: [safe decision context]. Include weighted criteria, an option comparison table, assumptions, likely failure modes, missing evidence, who should be consulted, and three final human judgment questions.

Meeting-to-Momentum Kit (60-90 minutes)

Convert a rough meeting idea into a focused agenda and follow-through packet.

Walk-away artifact: A timed agenda, participant prep note, decision log template, action-item table, and follow-up email draft.

Safe input: Use fictional or sanitized meeting context. Do not paste private attendee notes, personnel details, patient data, customer records, or proprietary plans into public tools.

- Describe the meeting purpose, attendees by role, time available, and desired output.
- Ask for a timed agenda with decisions, discussion prompts, and parking-lot items.
- Create a follow-up template with owners, due dates, unresolved questions, and confirmation language.
- Delete or rewrite anything that sounds like a promise, personnel judgment, or confidential detail.

Starter prompt: Using this fictional or sanitized meeting context, create a meeting kit: timed agenda, prep questions by role, likely tensions, decision log, action-item table, and follow-up email draft. Mark assumptions and anything a human should confirm before sending: [context].

Before-and-After Writing Studio (60 minutes)

Use AI as an editor, not a ghostwriter, and leave with a cleaner real draft.

Walk-away artifact: A revised email, memo, bio, announcement, or article with a change log, tone rationale, and final review checklist.

Safe input: Use a rough draft that contains no sensitive personal, client, patient, employee, legal, financial, or proprietary details.

- Paste a safe rough draft and name the audience, purpose, tone, and length limit.
- Ask for two alternative revisions: one clearer and one warmer or more concise.
- Have AI critique the revision for unsupported claims, missing context, and awkward tone.
- Make the final edits yourself and keep a before-and-after note on what improved.

Starter prompt: Revise this safe rough draft for [audience] with a [tone] tone and a [length] limit. Give me two versions, explain the changes, then critique the stronger version for clarity, unsupported claims, missing context, and anything I should verify before sending: [safe draft].

Research Launch Board (90-120 minutes)

Plan the research before the rabbit hole opens.

Walk-away artifact: A research board with question clusters, search strings, source ladder, opposing views, red flags, and claim-check table.

Safe input: Use a public topic or general business question. Do not ask AI to invent citations or make final claims without sources.

- Start with one broad public question and ask AI to break it into subquestions.
- Generate search strings, source categories, keywords to avoid, and missing perspectives.
- Ask for a claim-check table with columns for claim, source needed, confidence, and next action.
- Use the board to search actual sources; do not treat the model output as evidence.

Starter prompt: Help me build a research launch board for [public topic]. Create question clusters, search strings, source types, likely blind spots, opposing perspectives, red flags, and a claim-check table. Do not invent citations or make final claims without sources.

Workflow Recipe Card (90-120 minutes)

Turn one repeated task into a reusable recipe your future self can follow.

Walk-away artifact: A recipe card with trigger, safe inputs, prompt sequence, review gates, owner, time saved estimate, and stop signs.

Safe input: Choose a recurring task and describe it generally or with fictional examples. Keep sensitive operational data out of public tools.

- Write the current task steps from trigger to final output.
- Mark which inputs are safe, which must be generalized, and which should not enter a public tool.
- Ask AI to propose a prompt sequence and review checkpoints for the safest useful slice.
- Test the recipe with one fictional example and revise the steps until they are repeatable.

Starter prompt: Turn this recurring task into a safe AI-assisted workflow recipe: [task]. Include trigger, user, safe inputs, prompt sequence, expected output, review checkpoints, human owner, estimated time saved, risks, stop signs, and when not to use AI.

Professional Proof Portfolio (75-90 minutes)

Use AI to turn scattered experience into concrete positioning you can defend.

Walk-away artifact: A 150-word bio, six resume bullets, proof bank, interview answer outlines, and claims-to-evidence checklist.

Safe input: Use a sanitized career summary or fictionalized role description. Do not include private employer data, references, compensation, or confidential projects.

- Write a sanitized inventory of roles, strengths, projects, and outcomes you can discuss publicly.
- Ask AI to draft positioning options and separate claims from evidence.
- Create resume bullets and interview outlines, then remove anything inflated or unverifiable.
- Practice three interview questions and revise the language until it sounds true in your own voice.

Starter prompt: Using this sanitized professional summary, help me build a proof portfolio. Draft a 150-word bio, six resume bullet options, a proof bank, three interview answer outlines, and a claims-to-evidence checklist. Flag anything that sounds inflated or needs stronger evidence: [summary].

Seven-Day Action Plan (60-75 minutes)

Turn a vague goal into a week of small, scheduled actions.

Walk-away artifact: A seven-day plan with calendar blocks, next actions, obstacle responses, accountability note, and end-of-week review.

Safe input: Use personal goals and constraints that are not private, medical, financial, legal, or deeply sensitive.

- Describe the goal, available time, constraints, and what usually derails progress.
- Ask for a one-week plan with daily actions no longer than 45 minutes.
- Have AI identify likely obstacles and create if-then responses.
- Put the first two actions on your calendar and delete anything unrealistic.

Starter prompt: Help me turn this safe goal into a seven-day action plan: [safe goal]. Ask up to five clarifying questions if needed, then create calendar blocks, daily next actions under 45 minutes, obstacle responses, an accountability note, and an end-of-week review checklist.

Tangible cases

Meeting-to-action workflow

Situation: A team loses momentum after meetings because notes, decisions, and follow-up messages are inconsistent.

Learner task: Use fictional meeting notes to create a decision summary, action table, unresolved-questions list, and follow-up draft.

Starter prompt: Using these fictional meeting notes, create a meeting-to-action packet: decision summary, action-item table with owner and deadline placeholders, unresolved questions, follow-up email draft, and assumptions requiring human confirmation: [fictional notes].

Donor update workflow

Situation: A nonprofit has public program facts and a fictional event recap but keeps delaying donor updates because the first draft takes too long.

Learner task: Create a donor update packet with draft, subject lines, thank-you variants, claims-to-check list, and staff review note.

Starter prompt: Use only the public facts and fictional event notes below to draft a donor update packet. Include a 250-word update, five subject lines, two thank-you variants, a claims-to-verify checklist, and a staff review note. Do not use donor records or private beneficiary details: [safe notes].

Onboarding kit workflow

Situation: A growing team repeats the same process explanations every month and wants new staff to understand the sequence faster.

Learner task: Turn a public or sanitized process into a checklist, vocabulary list, practice scenario, quiz, and manager review guide.

Starter prompt: Turn this public or sanitized process into an onboarding kit. Include a role-specific checklist, key vocabulary, common mistakes, practice scenario, five-question quiz, manager review guide, and questions the process owner must answer: [process].

Policy explainer rewrite

Situation: A department has a dense internal policy that staff struggle to understand.

Learner task: Rewrite a public or sanitized policy excerpt into a staff explainer, glossary, exceptions list, and review note.

Starter prompt: Rewrite this public or sanitized policy excerpt for busy staff. Produce a plain-language explainer, glossary, exceptions or edge cases to ask about, change log, and policy-owner review checklist. Keep the meaning intact: [excerpt].

Research question map

Situation: A professional needs to explore an unfamiliar topic before deciding what sources to read.

Learner task: Use AI to create a research launch board with search strings, source ladder, blind spots, and claim-check table.

Starter prompt: Help me plan research on [topic]. Build a research launch board with question clusters, search strings, source types, likely blind spots, opposing perspectives, red flags, and a claim-check table. Do not make final claims without sources.

Specialty assistant for a repeated task

Situation: A team has a useful prompt sequence for meeting follow-ups, lesson kits, decision briefs, or writing review, but the sequence is too easy to forget or apply inconsistently.

Learner task: Convert the sequence into a Gem-style assistant blueprint with instructions, boundaries, examples, output format, review gates, and safe test cases.

Starter prompt: Help me design a narrow specialty assistant for this repeated task: [task]. Create a build sheet with purpose, user, required intake questions, operating instructions, output format, safety boundaries, claims to verify, human approval points, three safe test cases, three edge cases, and version notes. Do not assume private data can be used.

Prompt library

Workflow speed map

Map this recurring task for workflow acceleration without automating judgment. Create a before/after table with current steps, delays, AI-assist opportunities, safe inputs, expected artifact, human review gate, time-saved hypothesis, risks, stop signs, and owner: [task].

Specialty assistant build sheet

Turn this proven prompt workflow into a Gem-style specialty assistant build sheet. Include the assistant purpose, intended user, required intake questions, operating instructions, allowed inputs, prohibited inputs, output format, review gates, edge cases, safe test cases, owner, and version notes: [workflow].

Workflow recipe

Turn this recurring task into an AI-assisted workflow recipe card. Include trigger, user, safe inputs, prompt sequence, expected output, review checkpoints, human decision points, handoffs, risks, stop signs, and when not to use the workflow: [task].

Draft and critique

Create a first draft for [audience] using the safe context below. Then produce a critique table covering clarity, tone, unsupported claims, missing context, audience fit, and review needs. Finish with a revised version and a human-final checklist: [safe context].

Meeting preparation

Using this fictional meeting context, create a timed agenda, prep questions by role, likely tensions, decision log template, action table, and follow-up email shell. Keep assumptions visible and mark what a human must confirm: [fictional context].

Decision support

Compare these options without choosing for me. Create a decision brief with criteria, option matrix, assumptions, missing evidence, pre-mortem, stakeholder questions, and final human decision questions: [options].

Materials to develop

- Workflow recipe cards
- Meeting preparation worksheet
- Research triage checklist
- Before-and-after prompt examples
- Workflow documentation template
- Before-and-after workflow speed map
- Human review checkpoint guide
- Specialty assistant build sheet
- Gem-style instruction template

Diagram candidates

These are intentionally left as candidate visuals until diagram parameters are chosen.

- Human-in-the-loop workflow map
- Meeting-to-action pipeline
- Workflow recipe anatomy: inputs, AI assist, review, apply
- Workflow acceleration map: blank page, AI assist, human review, reusable artifact
- Specialty assistant lifecycle: recipe, instructions, safe tests, review, versioning

Follow-up work

- Pilot one documented workflow for two weeks using safe inputs.
- Track where the workflow saves time, improves quality, or creates review burden.
- Compare one before-and-after artifact so the team can see whether the workflow actually improved the work.
- Bring one workflow back for refinement before scaling it to a broader team.
- Decide whether the workflow should stay as a prompt card or become a maintained specialty assistant.

Session design reminders

- Keep examples non-sensitive and realistic.
- Emphasize education, judgment, review, and careful experimentation.
- Do not promise legal, medical, compliance, cybersecurity, or automation outcomes.
- Name when a stronger tool, private environment, or policy decision is needed before proceeding.

API and tool boundary

This curriculum companion does not require an API call. Any secure password protection, private client portal, or live AI workflow exercise that transmits data to an external model should be reviewed before implementation.